# Anupam Chugh

iOS & macOS engineer · former editor of Better Programming

I hold the board back until the right wave comes.

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> Eleven years building apps, two and a half editing other engineers. Both taught me the same thing: most of the work is noticing what someone is good at, then shaping the work around it. Five chapters.

## 01 The blogger

JournalDev · remote — 2015 – 2019

- Taught myself Android by writing it up as I learned: 300+ tutorials on Android, Java, Kotlin and Swift. Explaining a thing is how I find out I don't understand it yet.
- Built JournalDev's first Android app from scratch. The site was later acquired by DigitalOcean.

## 02 The remote builder

MOBEY, Gold Coast · Aged Care Decisions, Brisbane — 2015 – 2021

- Lead Android developer on MOBEY's alcohol-delivery apps, customer and driver, built from nothing; redesigned their iOS apps in 2017. MOBEY was featured on 7 News Brisbane.
- White-label iOS and Android apps for Aged Care Decisions, and a SwiftUI app for MomLikes in Chicago.
- Every team was an ocean away, so I learned to work in writing first.

## 03 The lead

Agricx, Bengaluru — 2018 – 2019

- Led the Android team and planned work with the web and ML teams.
- Built the company's first iOS app alone: a camera that grades crops on the device with OpenCV and AVFoundation.

## 04 The editor

Better Programming, Medium — 2021 – 2023

- Took over from Zack Shapiro in 2021 and ran it until September 2023; it has been on hiatus since I left. Read thousands of submissions a month with a small editor team.
- Started **Coffee Bytes** (2022 – 2023), a Medium newsletter that put other writers in front of readers: weekly picks, hand-picked roundups, author interviews, and *It's never too late or early to start something*, writers from age 10 to a septuagenarian learning Java.
- My job wasn't picking the best drafts. It was holding boards back until a writer understood what they set out to explain, and spotting whose second draft would beat everyone's first.
- Over its life the publication carried 4.6K authors, 16.8K stories and 151M views, and paid writers close to $1M.

## 05 The studio

Independent — 2024 – now

- Small Apple apps that each start from one human moment, live on the App Store: **Rifflet** turns a music idea into a lesson anyone can play, kids included; **Orbits** is the swipe for a trip or a meetup; **EchoHunt** exists because I play music at random hours and never knew why the algorithm picked it, so now I just ask.
- The swipe and the camera started as open samples: a Vision hand pose that throws a stack of cards, and a face-quality camera that became Best Face Forward.
- **Glint**, my own trading research agent: a Swift server on a Linux VPS takes live NSE and crypto ticks over WebSockets (Zerodha Kite, Binance), stores bars in SQLite and Parquet, and answers the iPhone and Mac apps, a CLI and an MCP tool. Agents can draft an order; none can place one without my one-time approval tied to that exact order and amount.
- I work with AI coding agents the way I worked with writers: one writes, a different one reviews, nobody grades their own work.
- Merged upstream: Xcode sessions in deja-vu, rules audit in Beads, usage fix in CodexBar, research mode in birdclaw, location settings in agent-device.

**Toolbox** Swift, SwiftUI, UIKit, Core ML, Vision, Foundation Models, ARKit · Kotlin, Android · Go, TypeScript, Python

**Education** BITS Pilani, Hyderabad · B.E. Computer Science · 2011 – 2015

**Elsewhere** Elsewhere: app showcase · satire at Humor Bytes · iowncode, 900+ stars of iOS ML and AR examples